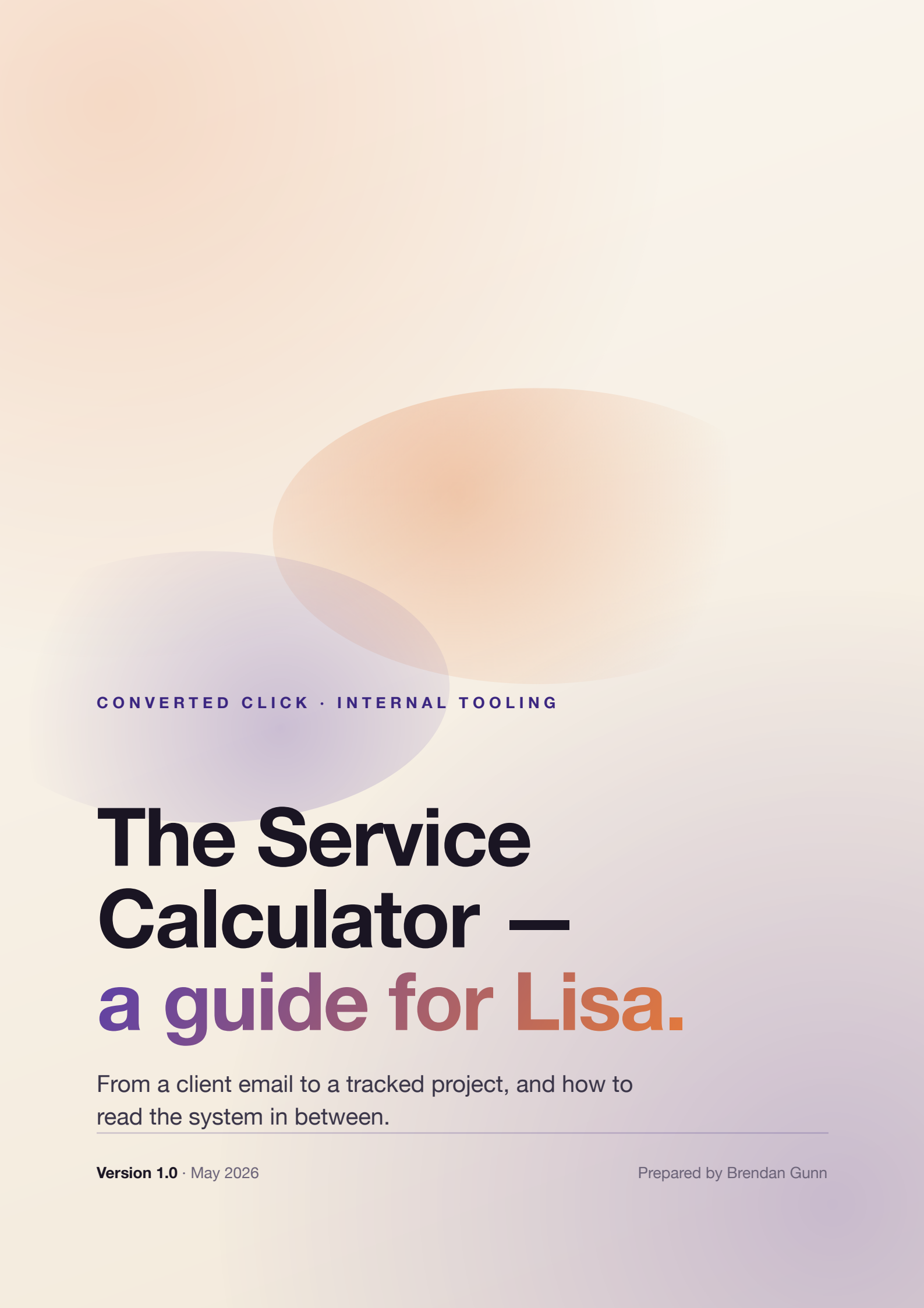




CONVERTED CLICK · INTERNAL TOOLING

# The Service Calculator — a guide for Lisa.

From a client email to a tracked project, and how to  
read the system in between.

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## WELCOME

# What this guide is for

The service calculator is the single place where a client conversation becomes a scoped, quoted, and tracked piece of work. This guide walks through how the pieces fit together, the journey of one piece of work through the system, what to do on each screen, and where I think the gaps are.

### WHAT'S IN THIS DOCUMENT

1. The big picture — system map
2. From email to tracked project
3. Inbox & brief triage
4. Scope editor
5. Project / Quote builder
6. Quote detail & send
7. Projects list and detail
8. Reconciliation
9. Pulse (retainer health)
10. Clients directory
11. Services catalog
12. Rules, Departments, Team
13. SOW templates & Settings
14. Gaps & what to build next

**Quick orientation.** The app lives at *cc-service-calculator* and is signed into with the shared team login. Every screen reads from one shared database, so what you change in one place is what everyone else sees a second later.

## 01 — THE BIG PICTURE

# How the parts connect

Four external systems feed in. Four internal stages move the work along. One database underneath holds the truth, and Claude AI sits next to it doing the first-pass thinking.

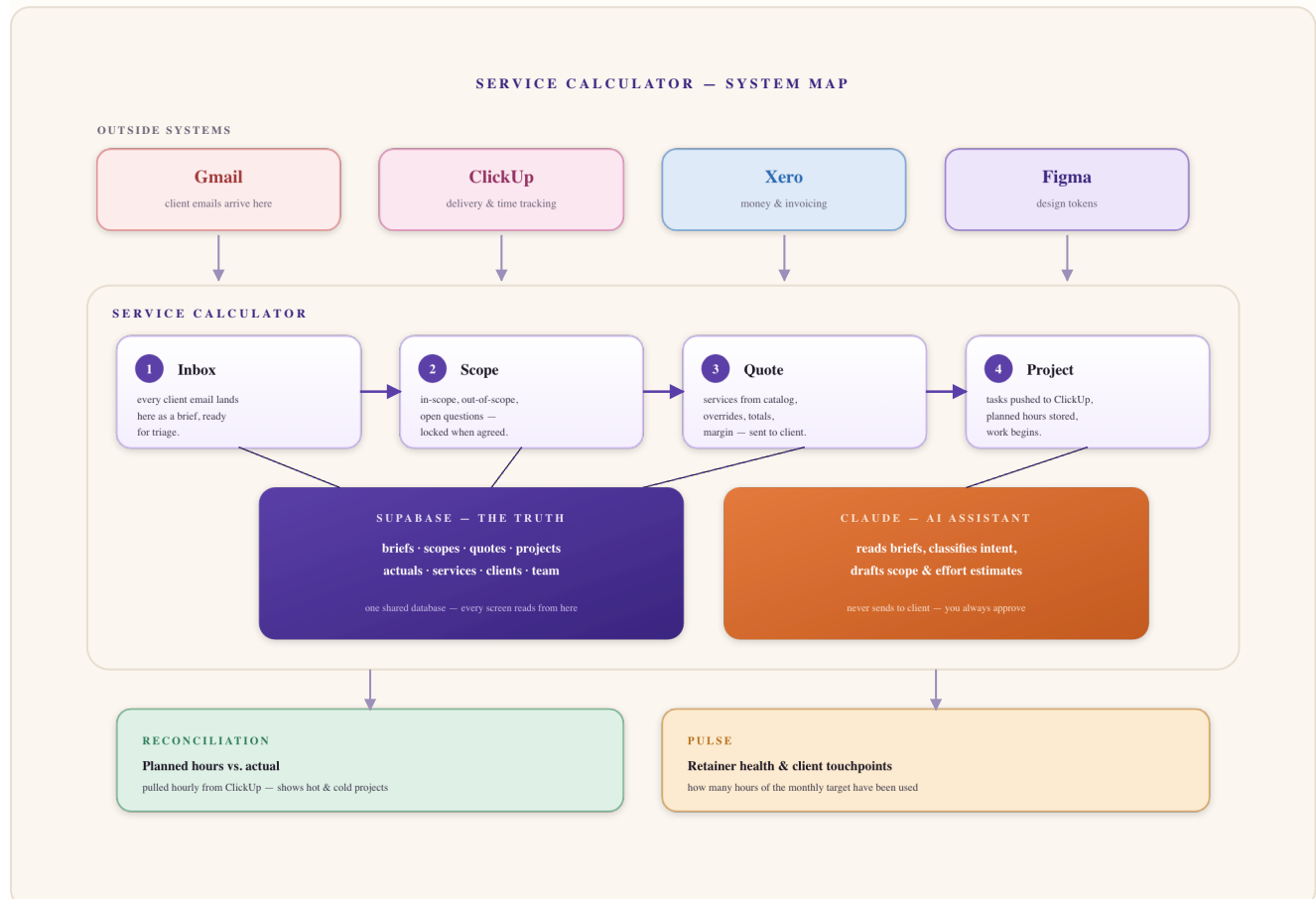


Figure 1 — Outside systems feed in at the top. The four core stages run left to right, all writing back to Supabase. Claude assists upstream of you. Reconciliation and Pulse close the loop.

**The single rule of thumb.** If a piece of work isn't somewhere in this diagram, it doesn't exist as far as the system is concerned. Every project should be traceable back to a brief, every brief back to a Gmail thread, every hour logged back to a project.

## 02 — THE JOURNEY

# From email to tracked project

Here's the same story, told as the journey of a single email through the system. Each card on the trail is a status the brief or project moves through. You only have to act on the cards in purple.

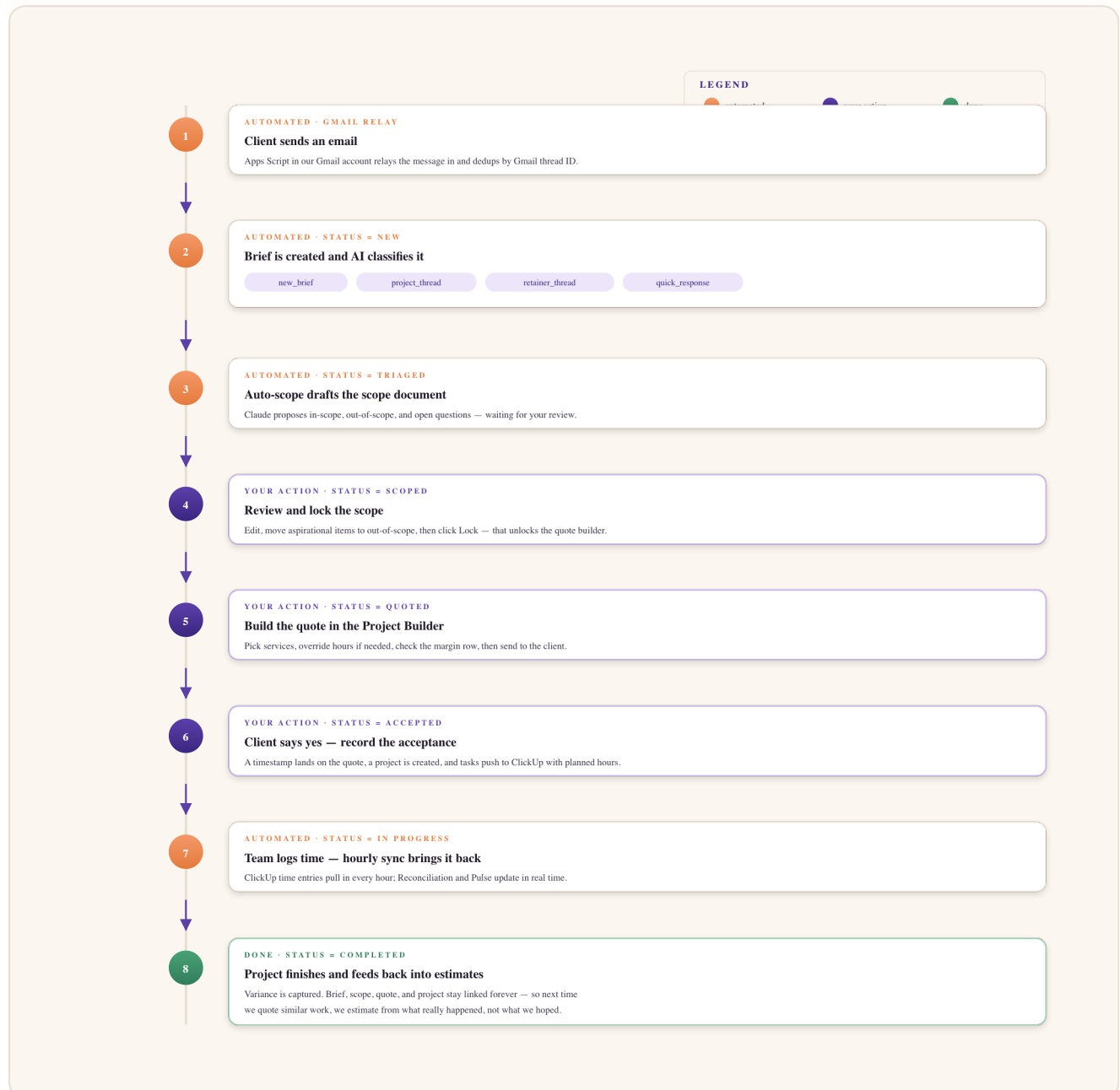


Figure 2 — The lifecycle of a single piece of work. Orange steps run automatically. Purple steps need you. Green is the finish line.

## 03 — THE SCREENS

# What each page does, and why

The pages below are in roughly the order you'll touch them in a typical week. Each card tells you what the screen is, how to use it, and why it matters to the team.

### 3.1 Inbox `/inbox`

#### WHAT IT IS

The triage list of every brief that's come in by email or been created manually. Each row is one client conversation.

#### HOW TO USE IT

Open in the morning. Anything *new* or *needs\_info* is waiting on you. Click a brief to see the Gmail thread on the left and the AI's proposed scope on the right. Filter by assignee, client, or status. Mark spam / duplicates immediately — don't leave them in *new*.

#### WHY IT MATTERS

This is the only place where the team agrees on what counts as work in flight. If a brief isn't in the Inbox, it's invisible to capacity planning.

### 3.2 Scope editor `/briefs/:id/scope`

#### WHAT IT IS

A structured document for one brief: in-scope, out-of-scope, open questions, and a prose summary. AI drafts it; you edit and lock it.

#### HOW TO USE IT

Read the AI's draft — don't trust it blindly. Add anything missing to in-scope. Move aspirational items to out-of-scope (this is your protection from scope creep). Write open questions as actual questions a client can answer in one line. Lock when ready.

#### WHY IT MATTERS

The scope is the contract before the contract. Every "but I thought that was included" disagreement traces back to a scope that wasn't precise.

### 3.3 Project Builder `/briefs/:id/builder`

#### WHAT IT IS

Turns a locked scope into a priced quote. Pick services from the catalog, override hours and department splits, see totals and margin live.

#### HOW TO USE IT

Start from the AI's suggested services. Add or remove until the line items match the scope bullets. Override at the line level for unusual jobs — don't change the catalog. Always check the margin row before sending.

#### WHY IT MATTERS

This is where time and money get committed. The hours you put here become the planned hours every downstream report compares against. Sloppy estimates here make every report a lie.

### 3.4 Quote detail & send `/quotes/:id`

#### WHAT IT IS

The read-only view of a generated quote, plus the form for sending it and capturing acceptance.

#### HOW TO USE IT

Review the SOW HTML before sending. The client sees what you see. When the client accepts (email, PDF, verbal), record it — that's what creates the project.

#### WHY IT MATTERS

"Accepted" is not a vibe — it's a row in the database with a date on it. That timestamp drives quote-to-start cycle time and tells Xero to issue the invoice.

### 3.5 Projects list & detail `/projects`

#### WHAT IT IS

Every project the team is delivering. The detail page links back to the brief, the quote, and the ClickUp parent task.

#### HOW TO USE IT

Use the list as your "what's the team on right now" view. Open a detail page to see planned vs. logged hours per service. Move stuck projects to cancelled — silent zombies skew capacity numbers.

#### WHY IT MATTERS

Projects are the unit we plan capacity against. Honest list = easy planning. Stale list = planning becomes fiction.

## 03 — THE SCREENS (CONT.)

### 3.6 Reconciliation /reconciliation

#### WHAT IT IS

The truth-telling page. Planned vs. actual hours for every active project, broken down by department. Pulls from ClickUp once an hour.

#### HOW TO USE IT

Weekly: walk the list, look for projects burning hot or cold. Hot = scope was wrong or time logged against wrong task. Cold = nobody's working it, or they are but aren't logging.

#### WHY IT MATTERS

The only place that closes the loop between what we promised and what we actually did. Without it, the quote builder's estimates never get better.

### 3.7 Pulse /pulse

#### WHAT IT IS

Retainer health. Hours used vs. monthly target per retainer client, plus a log of client touchpoints.

#### HOW TO USE IT

Friday afternoon, scan for retainers near 100% with weeks left in the month — that's a conversation to have *before* you overspend. Log touchpoints as they happen.

#### WHY IT MATTERS

Retainers die quietly. Either we burn through and feel resentful, or we don't burn through and the client feels they're not getting value. Pulse makes both visible.

### 3.8 Clients /clients

#### WHAT IT IS

The client directory. Each row links to the client's Xero contact, ClickUp folder, and (where set up) Obsidian wiki page.

#### HOW TO USE IT

Open a client to see their full history of briefs and projects. When onboarding, confirm Xero contact and ClickUp folder were created. Archive clients you haven't worked with in 12+ months.

#### WHY IT MATTERS

Clients are the spine the rest of the data hangs off. Wrong client on a brief = useless downstream reports for that revenue.

### 3.9 Services catalog [/services](#)

#### WHAT IT IS

The master list of things we sell. Each service has a price, a pricing model, default process steps, and a default department split.

#### HOW TO USE IT

Treat it like a recipe book — edits affect every future quote. Adding a new service: use Generate process steps for an AI draft, then refine. Archive rather than delete.

#### WHY IT MATTERS

Consistent catalog → consistent quotes → consistent margins. The catalog is what makes us look like one company rather than a collection of freelancers.

### 3.10 Rules & Departments [/rules](#) · [/departments](#)

#### WHAT IT IS

Rules are reusable percentage splits ("this kind of work is 60% dev / 30% design / 10% PM"). Departments are the buckets, with their own hourly and cost rates.

#### HOW TO USE IT

Mostly leave alone day-to-day. Touch when rates change, a new department spins up, or a recurring service is misallocated.

#### WHY IT MATTERS

These are the rails the quote builder runs on. Bad rates here = bad quotes everywhere.

### 3.11 Team, SOW templates & Settings [/team](#) · [/sow](#) · [/settings](#)

#### WHAT IT IS

Team roster (rates, skills); master SOW templates with reusable clauses and tiered pricing; the connection settings for Xero, ClickUp, and Gmail.

#### HOW TO USE IT

Keep team cost rates current. Edit SOW boilerplate centrally so it's consistent everywhere. Settings → Gmail is where the relay token lives — set once, forget.

#### WHY IT MATTERS

Without these connections the app is an island. With them, it's the hub the whole agency runs through.

## 04 — GAPS

# What's missing & worth building next

Honest gaps. None of these block today's work, but each would pay back the time spent building it. Priorities are my best guess — open to revision.

### Per-user accountability **HIGH**

Everyone signs in as a shared team user. We can't tell who triaged what, locked which scope, or sent which quote. Lightweight per-user login (identity only, no roles yet) unlocks weekly "what did each person move" reports and audit trails.

### Notifications & daily digest **HIGH**

Nothing notifies you. You have to remember to check Inbox and Reconciliation. A daily morning digest (new briefs, retainers near cap, projects with no time logged in 5+ days) by email or Slack would replace one standing meeting.

### Win / loss tracking **MEDIUM**

We capture *accepted* and *rejected*, but not *why*. A short structured reason on rejection (price, timing, lost to competitor, never replied) plus a quarterly view tells us whether we're too expensive or too slow. Right now we guess.

### Forecast / pipeline view **MEDIUM**

We see what's in progress, not what's likely to come in. A weighted pipeline (quoted × 50%, scoped × 25%) turns the Inbox into a forecast — useful for capacity planning and cashflow modelling.

### Search across briefs & projects **MEDIUM**

No global search. To find "that thing we did for client X about Y last year," you have to remember the client and scroll. Full-text search across briefs, scopes, and quotes turns the system into institutional memory.

### Quick-reply templates **MEDIUM**

AI drafts a single reply for *quick\_response* intents, but there's no reusable template library ("thanks, scope to you Friday"). A handful of templates covers ~70% of replies and keeps tone consistent across the team.

### Margin / profitability rollup **LOW-MED**

We see planned margin on a quote and actual hours on Reconciliation, but no page does the multiplication. Closes the financial loop — "which services are actually profitable" rather than "which sell most."

### Mobile-friendly Inbox **LOW**

App assumes a laptop. The Inbox in particular is hard to triage on a phone. A read-and-tag-only mobile view (no quote building) would save laptop time for actual scoping work.

### Client-facing read-only view **LOW (BIG**

#### **OPTICS)**

Clients see emails and PDFs from us, never the live state of their project. A scoped read-only page (planned hours used, next milestones, open questions) would reduce "where are we?" emails. Strong differentiator at sales time.

### Onboarding tour **LOW**

No in-app guidance. New starters learn by shadowing. Simple first-visit tooltips would shrink time-to-useful from weeks to days.

## Where to ask questions

- **Anything broken or confusing in the app** — message Brendan directly.
- **Anything this doc gets wrong** — the source markdown lives at *docs/lisa-guide.md* in the repo. Pull request it, or just tell me.
- **Anything that should be a feature** — drop it into the Inbox as a brief addressed to Converted Click. We dogfood our own intake.